

Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes

Date: 04/16/2026

Host: Wayne Township

Call to Order: Meeting called to order at 6:26 PM by Allen Freeman with the following CCTA Officers & Active Members in attendance:

Batavia Township:

Trustee Danielle Wessel

Goshen Township:

Trustee / CCTA Vice-President Bob Hausermann

Monroe Township:

Trustee Tom Peck

Ohio Township:

Trustee Keith Vogelsang

Trustee Scott Wolf

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Allen Freeman

Stonelick Township:

Trustee Edward Cooper

Tate Township:

Fiscal Officer Kathy Brannock

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Wayne Township:

Trustee Teresa Hinnners

Fiscal Officer Warren Walker

Williamsburg Township:

Trustee Guy Bainum

Trustee Charlie Maklem

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

Mr. Freeman gave the floor to Teresa Hinnners who offered a brief introduction of the staff thanking them for their work with setup for tonight's meeting. Ms. Hinnners was then asked to lead the group in the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance. Mr. Freeman then asked Guy Bainum to offer a prayer. Immediately thereafter the group was invited to get dinner.

At approximately 7:00 PM, Mr. Freeman called the meeting back to order. Mr. Freeman gave Mr. Hausermann the floor to discuss Goshen Township's letter to P.U.C.O. regarding Duke Energy's proposed rate increases. Mr. Freeman asked Mr. Hausermann what the due date would be for those letters, and Mr. Hausermann replied that there is plenty of time as the submittal deadline is some time in the fall. Mr. Hausermann read out the letter Goshen Township had sent, and some discussion follow about forwarding the letter to all the Townships' Board Chairs with encouragement that they also prepare and send their own letters to P.U.C.O.

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Mr. Freeman also suggested that the CCTA should send its own letter signed by the Officers. He asked that each individual township produce, sign, and send their own letters and send a copy to Mr. Baird so we can keep track of how many letters have been sent. He also presented that, if the membership was ok with it, we would draft our own letter signed by the Association's officers and send it as well.

Upon conclusion of Mr. Hausermann's discussion on the P.U.C.O. letter, Mr. Freeman asked Mr. Baird to present the Treasurer's report.

Mr. Baird presented the Treasurer's report for March 2026. No deposits or withdrawals had been received for the month, and cash-on-hand remained at \$3,068.49. A motion was brought by Mr. Hausermann to approve the Treasurer's report as read, seconded by Mr. Peck. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Freeman moved on asking Mr. Baird to give an update about the membership drive. Mr. Baird shared that the 2026-27 OTA membership drive is now underway. Invoices will be going out very soon to the townships and reminded everyone about the affiliate membership's and that now is the time to bring on any township employees that could benefit from membership in the CCTA/OTA.

Ms. Hinnners asked Mr. Baird if this is the time to add township employees so they can participate in the OTA Education subscription. Mr. Baird affirmed that yes, this is the time and method to do so. Mr. Baird also reminded everyone of the Affiliate and Associate memberships and eligibility requirements of each, and that he believed Affiliate membership is also available to members of Township Zoning Commissions and Boards of Zoning Appeals. Mr. Baird said he would confirm with OTA regarding those boards' eligibility for membership.

Mr. Baird also shared more details about the benefits and value of the OTA's Education subscription, and the substantial savings over a-la-carte webinar purchases.

Mr. Freeman then turned the members' attention to the April meeting's tabled question regarding the donation request from the Clermont County Junior Fair Board that had been sent to Batavia Township Fiscal Officer Jennifer Haley who had forwarded it to him. Mr. Freeman asked Mr. Baird to remind those present what the request is about, and if there is an amount they are requesting. Discussion followed about the donation amount, and whether the CCTA wanted to sponsor a specific species. Following discussion, a motion was brought by Mr. Bainum to donate \$200 to the Clermont County Junior Fair Board, seconded by Mr. Cooper. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Freeman introduced tonight's guest speaker Mr. Bill DeHass, CEO of Clermont County Senior Services who asked to speak tonight about the services his organization offers and about the forthcoming tax levy that will be on the May 2026 ballot. Mr. DeHass took the floor. A brief Q&A followed his presentation.

Upon conclusion of Mr. DeHass' presentation and Q&A, Mr. Freeman brought the CCTA's attention to the legislative agenda. Mr. Freeman moved on to discuss the CCTA Legislative agenda briefing the members on the movement for eliminating property taxes, the updated qualification methods due to recent legislative changes by the General Assembly for how those initiatives get on the ballot. The conversation

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continued with anecdotes members shared about the issue. Additional concerns around this issue, beyond the petitions and potential ballot initiatives is rhetoric from current candidates for state offices.

Concerns that were discussed from the township government perspective revolved around the effect these changes could have on the services that townships are required to provide to their community by statute, and how those services could continue faced with the significant reductions in revenues.

Mr. Freeman asked the association for their consensus on the existing draft legislative agenda, if there are other items members see that need to be added, and if the membership feels it is ready. Mr. Freeman shared that if the association feels its thorough and completed, he will look to draft a letter to send to our state representatives to begin sharing and pushing on our initiatives.

The discussion continued with ruminations on how townships may need to address those shortfalls. Mr. Freeman shared that he had spoken with the Clermont County Auditor, and that if property tax abolition did happen to qualify for the November 2026 ballot and pass, that townships would still be funded through 2027 since the property taxes are collected in arrears. Members also considered the effect this might have on TIFs and bonds, and the likely scenario that lenders would almost certainly file legal challenges that would tie the issue up in the courts for quite some time.

Mr. Hausermann also shared the status of Goshen Township's marijuana related tax revenue and how significant the receipts have been. Though it was a very conversational issue in his township, but they ultimately moved forward with it because they recognized the long-term positive benefits.

Mr. Freeman then moved on asking the members if there was a desire to have a follow up discussion on the topic of having a June meeting in Ohio Township, bringing back the CCTA's annual picnic.

Mr. Vogelsang responded that, as he had committed to at the last meeting, he brought it up with his Township. He shared that at that meeting that had been at previous picnics had concerns over the fact that a lot of food had gone to waste, and that the cost used to be borne by the CCTA but now that it is paid for by the townships that there were concerns that so few people attended and it cost them a lot of money.

Mr. Hausermann shared that pre-Covid the host township would always provide dinner, with a \$400 budget, and the CCTA members attending would donate \$5 each which would help to reimburse the host township. The practice ended during Covid and when the CCTA was able to return to in-person meetings, the first was hosted by Union Township who provided dinner to the attendees. Since then, it has continued and the CCTA has not resumed the pass-the-hat collection to help defray the cost to the host township. He suggested that if the CCTA would like to go back to gathering those donations we should consider doing so and asked if that might allay Mr. Vogelsang's expressed concerns.

Mr. Vogelsang replied that what he thinks it's all about is that since some townships don't have meetings and thus don't provide dinner that it seems a bit unfair to those townships that do. He then asked when the proposed Ohio township meeting might be, if it was decided to move forward with it.

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Mr. Freeman shared that it was discussed at the March meeting, and the CCTA decided to table it from that meeting for further discussion at tonight's meeting. Mr. Vogelsang asked Mr. Baird what might be on the agenda for the next meeting and where it would be. Mr. Baird shared that the next meeting would be in Goshen on the third Thursday in May, and that we don't have regular meeting scheduled for June or July.

The schedule was then discussed for the rest of the year, and then Mr. Freeman turned the topic to the question of having a Christmas party in December. We always had to do it on Mondays due to the availability of the venue. The cost per person was also discussed, with recollection that it used to be \$50.

Mr. Freeman reminded that if we wanted to schedule something for June we would need to move quickly with a decision, and that it wouldn't have to be hosted by Ohio Township, and if the decision was a firm "no" that that's fine as well. Mr. Vogelsang stated that it was his understanding that he needed to give an answer, and that is why he raised the questions that had been expressed within his township meeting, and that "no" was the impression he got. Mr. Freeman pointed out that we could slide it into any other township and suggested that we might consider raising the question with Miami Township as well to see if they might consider taking the June picnic.

Mr. Vogelsang shared that he thinks bringing back the \$5 donation is a good idea because of the cost providing dinner puts to the host township. The membership seemed to be of the same opinion, but nothing was firmly decided on the question.

Discussion continued around ideas for collecting a donation from the members attending the meetings, and ideas were brought up about a "split-the-pot" sort of attraction. The conversation also turned toward the topic of fundraising, which Ms. Wessel reminded had been previously brought up at the January meeting and that it has stayed parked since then.

Mr. Freeman suggested that we need to pull the fundraising topic back to the active agenda and proposed that we get a group together to handle it. Nothing was firmly decided, but it was suggested that Ms. Wessel might lead the effort. Context was shared with the group about how the CCTA used to pursue donations for the spring Banquet which used to be held in April. A topic of a silent auction was also brought forward. Mr. Freeman said we would send out an invite to get a fundraising group to have a short meeting to discuss more ideas. Mr. Baird asked Mr. Freeman if we were creating a fundraising sub-committee to which Mr. Freeman said no, it will just be an informal initial brainstorming discussion.

Mr. Freeman reminded that the next meeting will be May 21st in Goshen Township. He then asked if anyone else had any further announcements they would like to share. Mr. Hausermann shared that Goshen Township will be holding an open house on May 8th at their new fire station, and that everyone is welcome to come but that they will also get a tour at the May 21st meeting. Mr. Freeman shared that Kris McClintock has been wanting to make a presentation to the CCTA and suggested that we should try to invite him to present at the May meeting. Mr. Walker suggested, back on the topic of fundraising, that perhaps we could consider a golf outing which usually go well for fundraising initiatives.

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Mr. Bainum expressed thanks again to Wayne Township for the wonderful dinner, to which the CCTA had a round of applause. Mr. Freeman again called for any last announcements from any members. There being none, he called for a motion to adjourn.

Mr. Bainum moved to adjourn the meeting, seconded by Mr. Peck. Meeting adjourned at 8:10 PM.